

Edward Vartanessian

Platform Engineer — AWS · Terraform · Python · OpenTelemetry

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SUMMARY

Software engineer specializing in cloud platforms, automation, and observability. 6+ years building on AWS with Terraform and Python: reliability automation for a 10,000+ device fleet at Splunk (custom OpenTelemetry Collector fleet-wide, SLO-driven auto-remediation) and a greenfield procurement platform replacing legacy enterprise SaaS at Cisco. Building Copywarden, an encrypted macOS clipboard manager (copywarden.com). Security-first: zero-trust design and compliance automation for SOC 2, ISO 27001, and UK Cyber Essentials.

SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: Python, Swift (SwiftUI), TypeScript (React, Next.js), JavaScript, Bash, PowerShell, HCL (Terraform)

Cloud & Infrastructure: AWS (Lambda, EC2, S3, CloudFront, Route 53, Secrets Manager, IAM), Terraform, Docker, Kubernetes, Puppet

CI/CD: GitLab CI, GitHub Actions, Docker-based pipelines, GitOps, code signing & notarization

Observability & SRE: OpenTelemetry, Splunk, Prometheus, Grafana, SLOs/SLIs, incident management

Platforms & Security: ServiceNow development (scripting, workflows, REST integrations), Okta/IAM-as-code, CrowdStrike, Jamf, Installinator, Tenable, SonarQube, SOC 2 / ISO 27001

EXPERIENCE

Cisco — Software Engineer, Platform · DX Automation Engineering

Sept 2025 – Present · joined via Cisco's acquisition of Splunk

- Architecting and building a **greenfield internal procurement + ITSM platform on AWS** replacing two enterprise SaaS platforms — Lambda, RDS, S3, CloudFront, Route 53, IAM and VPC networking, infrastructure defined in Terraform, delivered by GitHub Actions CI/CD
- Designed and stood up the **self-service machine-ordering site end to end**, serving a ~100,000-employee company
- Building the platform's data layer on **Amazon RDS with Drizzle schema migrations run through CI**
- Built ServiceNow automations and integrations — server-side scripting, workflow automation, REST integrations — eliminating manual fulfillment steps
- Own incident management for **device automation** across the fleet: automated triage, runbooks, and post-incident fixes that prevent repeats

Splunk — Client Platform Engineer (DevOps/SRE)

Apr 2022 – Sept 2025

- Engineered automation and observability for a **global 10,000+ device fleet** (macOS/Windows/Linux) with zero-downtime updates, sustaining SOC 2, ISO 27001, and UK Cyber Essentials compliance
- Built fleet-wide observability on OpenTelemetry + Splunk: defined health/compliance SLIs — patch currency, security-agent liveness, configuration drift, enforcement latency — with SLO-backed alerting in place of a ticket queue
- Built and shipped a custom OpenTelemetry Collector distribution** — authored the OCB manifest to compile a minimal purpose-built binary instead of deploying vendor agents, then packaged, Developer ID-signed, and Apple-notarized it for endpoint distribution at Splunk and Cisco; identified its missing macOS CPU/disk host metrics (official builds ship CGO_ENABLED=0) and drove the fix upstream — authored proposal opentelemetry-collector-contrib #33393, since implemented
- Built a self-service CLI for the security team** that created Jamf software restrictions in seconds instead of minutes of console clicking — removing myself as the bottleneck for a recurring request
- Brought GitOps to fleet configuration:** put ~300 Jamf scripts and extension attributes under version control with peer-reviewed merge requests and a GitLab CI pipeline that deployed to production on merge, replacing hand-edits in a web console; wrote the API extraction tooling that seeded the repo and later migrated the configuration during the Cisco acquisition

- **Replaced a legacy Perl patcher that force-quit users' applications mid-meeting with a Python patching service** (Installomator + custom packages): stages updates in the background, applies on next app relaunch, and defers while a user is in a meeting — reaching **97–99% macOS patch compliance fleet-wide** (effectively every device that came online) with no user interruption, and ending recurring audit findings for stale software
- Cut security state-change enforcement from hours to **<15 minutes** — the management check-in floor — against a 3-minute security target, using SLO-backed alerts and Python/Bash auto-remediation; prototyped local polling daemons to close the remaining gap. Staged **global** OS rollouts in geographic waves targeted by IP range after opt-in UAT sign-off, containing the blast radius of a bad change to one region
- Built **self-healing recovery for always-on security agents** (CrowdStrike, Code42): each management plane could repair the other, so a downed agent or broken management framework recovered without hands-on remediation
- Built Docker-based GitLab CI/CD pipelines; automated AWS (Lambda, EC2, S3, CloudFront, Secrets Manager) with Terraform; owned Puppet for config/state enforcement; led fleet vulnerability remediation (Tenable, SonarQube) against SLAs
- Carried the team's **weekly on-call rotation** (VictorOps, later Splunk On-Call) — including through the 2024 CrowdStrike outage that took Windows endpoints down fleet-wide
- **Chosen by the Director as a technical interviewer for the team's hires — including the incoming manager**, plus senior and junior engineers

Starburst Data — IT / Cloud Engineer

Dec 2020 – Jan 2022

- **Owned Okta as the company IDP and the Harbor container registry** — the company's only IT engineer, running multi-cloud infrastructure in Terraform as headcount grew from ~100 to 300
- Codified Okta IAM in Terraform (groups, app assignments, SCIM): least-privilege access by default and same-day onboarding/offboarding through the growth
- **Automated container-registry access end to end** — replaced hand-provisioning with a Jira → Harbor API workflow issuing scoped credentials with an audit trail, cutting turnaround from hours to minutes; scoped the design and brought in a software engineer for the Jira API integration

Earlier career — Systems & IT Engineering

2013 – 2020 · Arent Fox, McDermott Will & Emery, LiveCare

- Enterprise Windows/macOS environments, Azure/O365 administration, PowerShell automation, VoIP migration lead

SELECTED PROJECTS

- **Copywarden** — copywarden.com — encrypted, screen-share-aware clipboard manager for macOS, designed and built solo: **~85,000 lines of Swift 6** (strict concurrency) across 6 modules, with AES-256-GCM, HKDF-derived per-item keys, Secure Enclave key wrapping, Argon2id account crypto, and a downgrade-attack defense binding the envelope version into the AEAD tag. Signed and notarized universal builds, published threat model and disclosure policy, Next.js/TypeScript site on S3 + CloudFront. Built AI-assisted behind an enforced pre-push gate — lint, secret scanning, tiered test lanes, and a claims linter that fails the build on unsupported copy
- **iRacing telemetry platform** — OpenTelemetry-native racing telemetry, built solo: each lap a trace, each corner a span, shipped over OTLP. FastAPI backend (16 data models, 14 routers, versioned migrations), six analysis services, and a packaged Windows collector released through GitHub Actions
- **OpenTelemetry Collector** (open source) — authored the upstream proposal for macOS CPU/disk host-metrics support (opentelemetry-collector-contrib #33393, since implemented)
- **evartanessian.dev** — this resume's claims, demonstrated: a static site that publishes its own live SLOs and error budget from real-user monitoring and synthetic probes; keyless OIDC CI deploys; S3 + CloudFront + ACM in Terraform; source and pipeline public (github.com/eddiev2)

EDUCATION

Eastern Nazarene College — B.A., Computer Science